



Slop / University

Never Wait for a Washer Again

Real-Time Laundry Certainty Across Every
Hall of Residence



An invitation

A university is, before it is anything else, a place where several thousand people share a small number of washing machines. Slop University's Halls of Residence now carry a live laundry-availability network across every floor: a status panel by the machine bank that tells a resident, before they carry a basket down two flights of stairs, whether a machine is actually free.

It is a small thing to get right, and the University has treated it as seriously as everything else it measures. The same sensing instinct that watches over research infrastructure, timetabling, and the courtyards between lectures now watches over the laundry room too — because campus life is made of exactly this kind of small, recurring uncertainty, and removing it, one shared space at a time, is a version of the University's broader work that every resident can feel on a Tuesday evening.

This brochure is an invitation to see that work up close: in the halls where you'll live, on the paths that get you here, and in the shared spaces the whole community keeps returning to.



The short version

A short account of what makes campus feel dependable, day to day.



Residential life

Halls of residence carry services built to remove one familiar uncertainty from a resident's evening, not to make headlines about it.



Campus movement

Stops, shelters, and shuttle timing are reviewed against how the campus actually moves, not only how it was drawn up to move.



Shared spaces

Courtyards, lobbies, and laundry rooms are treated as infrastructure worth watching, the same as any lab.

What we do

Where You Live

Residential life runs on dozens of small shared systems most universities leave to chance: a laundry room, a parcel-locker bank, a lobby noticeboard. Slop University instruments the ones that matter most to a resident's week. The parcel-locker network across the Halls of Residence now tells a resident when a package is ready before they walk past an empty locker door — the same certainty the laundry-availability network extends to the machine room downstairs.



A resident shouldn't have to learn a building's rhythms by trial and error. The locker network and the laundry network are the same idea, in two different rooms.

— Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Getting You There

Getting around Slop University is a research question the University keeps asking of itself. When the East Precinct shuttle stop moved forty metres closer to the newest teaching buildings, the change was reviewed the way the University reviews everything it relies on: against what people actually did next, not only against what the relocation was meant to achieve.



Moving a shuttle stop is a small decision with a large footprint across a community's daily walk. It deserves the same scrutiny as anything else the University commits to.

— Kwame Lindqvist, Associate Professor, School of Emergent Priorities

Shared Ground

Spring on campus means magpies, and magpies mean a familiar seasonal choreography of warning signs along the paths people actually swoop through. The University now times and places those signs against the swoop pattern itself, so a shared courtyard stays a shared courtyard for everyone who crosses it — staff, students, and visiting family alike.



A warning sign only does its job if it's where the birds are, not where the paperwork says the birds were last year.

— Anouk Mensah, Postdoctoral Fellow, School of Emergent Priorities

From our researchers

The instinct behind the laundry-availability network runs through the University's published record.

- **Locker Ping** — a field-tested reminder system that lets a resident know the moment a parcel is ready for collection. [doi:10.5555/slop.x8pxcz](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.x8pxcz)
- **Same Feet, Shorter Walk** — a fourteen-week study of what actually changed once a shuttle stop moved closer to where people needed it. [doi:10.5555/slop.d7z13b](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.d7z13b)
- **Posted Early, Swooped All the Same** — a comparison of warning-sign timing that puts a shared courtyard's safety ahead of the calendar. [doi:10.5555/slop.gwvlkm](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.gwvlkm)

Meet the researchers

Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities, studies why an initiative that never quite gets confirmed can still run for years on renewed provisional budgets — the same patient attention to what a system quietly does, brought to bear here on the everyday spaces every resident shares.

Anouk Mensah, Postdoctoral Fellow, School of Emergent Priorities, traces how the language of a plan outlives the plan itself, carrying that same eye for what persists unexamined into the shared spaces students and staff pass through every day.

Be part of it

None of this asks anyone to notice it working. A resident who finds a washing machine free on the first try, or catches the shuttle without checking three timetables, or walks under a magpie's territory without a swoop, has simply had an ordinary day. That ordinariness is the point, and it is built one shared space at a time, by people who think as carefully about a courtyard sign as they do about a research grant.

Slop University is open to anyone who wants to see how that attention scales — across a laundry room, a locker bank, a shuttle stop, a lawn — to the rest of a shared campus life. Visit slop.university to read more from the schools and researchers behind it, and to see what the University is watching next.



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